cannot hear sounds with frequencies below 20 Hz or above 20000 Hz. So, the above range is called as audible range of sound.

Infrasonic sound

A sound with a frequency, below 20 Hz is called as subsonic or infrasonic sound. Humans cannot hear the sound of this frequency, but some animals like dog, dolphin, etc., can hear. Uses of infrasonic sound are:

- It is employed in the earth monitoring system.
- It is also used in the study of the mechanism of human heart.

Ultrasonic sound

A sound with a frequency greater than 20000 Hz is called as ultrasonic sound. Animals such as bats, dogs, dolphins, etc., are able to hear certain ultrasonic sounds as well. Some of the uses of ultrasonic sounds are:

- It is extensively used in medical applications like 'sonogram'.
- It is used in the SONAR system to detect the depth of the sea and to detect enemy submarines.
- It is also employed in dish washers.
- Another important application of ultra sound is the Galton's whistle. This whistle is inaudible to the human ear, but it can be heard by the dogs. It is used to train the dogs for investigation.



A bat can hear the sounds of frequencies higher than 20,000 Hz. Bats produce ultrasonic sound during screaming. These ultrasonic waves help them to locate their way and the prey.

6.5 Musical Instruments

Some sounds are pleasing to the ear and make us happy. The sound that provides a pleasing sensation to the ear is called 'music'. Music is produced by the regular patterns of vibrations. Musical instruments are categorized into four types as given below.

- Wind instruments
- Reed instruments
- Stringed instruments
- Percussion instruments

Wind instruments

In a wind instrument the sound is produced by the vibration of air in a hollow tube. The frequency is varied by changing the length of the vibrating air column. Trumpet, Flute, Shehnai and Saxophone are some well-known wind instruments.

Reed instruments

A reed instrument contains a reed. Air, which is blown through the instrument, causes the reed to vibrate, which in turn produces the specific sound. Examples of reed instruments include Harmonium and Mouth Organ.

Stringed instruments

Stringed instruments make use of a string or wire to produce vibrations and hence the specific sound. These instruments also have hollow boxes that amplify the sound that is produced. The frequency of sound is varied by varying the length of the vibrating wire. Violin, Guitar, Sitar are some of the examples of stringed instruments.

A guitar string has a number of frequencies at which it will naturally vibrate. These natural frequencies are known as the **harmonics** of the guitar string. The natural frequency, at which an object vibrates, depends upon the tension of the string, the linear density of the string and the length of the string.

Percussion instruments

Percussion instruments produce a specific sound when they are struck, scrapped or

8th_Science_Unit-6_EM.indd 65 12/1/2022 3:34:26 PM